The Nature of Man

Purpose: *To show that man does not possess immortality, life is found in Christ alone. To identify man's soul and what happens when we die.*

Centred on*: Jesus holds the keys of hell and death that unlocks the mystery of these important subjects. Jesus' death loses its mystery and its sting and becomes a blessed rest on the journey home.*

In order to understand what death is like, we need to understand what life is, as life is ultimately the opposite of death.

Revelation 1:18… Jesus has the keys of hell and death. Jesus can unlock the mystery of these important subjects.

Genesis 3:4… The idea that when we die, we do not really die, is the very first lie that was ever told by the devil.

Genesis 2:7… A living soul is a living being, a person. What makes us a living soul or being? Let's break down the Genesis formula. First, we have dust. Then the breath of life, which is the spirit of God, and those two together form a living being or soul. The Biblical formula looks like this:

DUST

+ SPIRIT

= A LIVING SOUL

Or we could write it out like this:

ELEMENTS OF THE EARTH

+ BREATH OF LIFE

+ A LIVING BEING

Ecclesiastes 12:7… So, now that we have the formula for life, in order to understand death we would simply reverse it. Death is simply creation in reverse.

Psalms 146:3, 4…When the spirit or breath of God goes from us, in that very day we die and our thoughts perish:

So here is the formula for death as the Bible teaches it:

ELEMENTS OF THE EARTH

— BREATH OF LIFE

= A DEAD BODY

Two illustrations for this formula: One is with a light (bulb and electricity). The second is a wooden box (boards and nails).

Ecclesiastes 9:5…The dead know nothing therefore they do not visit the living, or communicate with them in any way.

1 Timothy 6:16…The Bible teaches that only God is immortal. The King James Version of the Bible uses the word soul 1600 times but never once does it use the term immortal soul.

1 Corinthains 15:51-54… Human beings are mortal. We are to seek immortality and we will receive it through our faith in Jesus Christ at the resurrection. Death, the Bible teaches, is like a sleep.

John 11:11-14…Jesus used the expression of sleeping when speaking of death.

From Genesis to Revelation, sleep is used as an illustration of death. Old Testament writers used the phrase "slept (or rested) with their fathers as an expression of death.

Acts 2:29, 34…The Bible teaches that there is no life after death until the resurrection. Believers do not go directly to heaven when they die. <u>NT and post Pentecost.</u>

2 Corinthians 11:14, 15…What about people who have both seen and talked to departed loved ones? The Bible is very clear about the state of the dead. It also warns us about the wonder-working power of Satan and his angels. It is possible for Satan to transform himself into an angel of light, to talk through a serpent (Genesis 3), impersonate a dead prophet (Samuel) and to impersonate departed loved ones.

Job 14:10-15…Job understood the process of life, death and resurrection. Man, "lies down" and does not "rise again." He "waits" until the "heavens are no more" and his "change" comes. (Job 3:11-19)

Appeal

According to the Bible death is a sleep from which all who trust in Jesus will awake to receive the gift of eternal life. When people die they do not go directly to heaven to watch their loved one suffer on earth. Neither do they try to communicate with us. They are in an unconscious state of sleep until the resurrection. What a wonderful truth! Jesus has abolished death. He has turned our greatest fear into an unconscious sleep from which we awake to receive the reality of immortality. Jesus longs for you to accept that reality by faith now. Won't you say, "yes," unworthy as you are and accept His sacrifice? All of heaven will ring with praise and shout with the voice of jubilation.

Defend it

Luke 23:42,43… There are two important points to consider concerning these verses. First of all, the meaning of the text in question depends greatly on the punctuation. The Bible was not originally written with punctuation. Punctuation was added centuries after the Bible was written and, notably, after the pagan influence of death had come into the church.

In addition, Jesus could not have meant that the thief would be with Him in paradise that day, because Christ did not go to paradise on the day of His crucifixion **(John 20:17).**

2 Corinthians 5:1-8… If death is like a sleep, an unconscious state from which we are awakened by the voice of Christ on resurrection morning, then time is nothing in death. When we die, the very next moment of our consciousness is that of rising from the grave to be with the Lord.

In addition, the context of these passages are speaking of three states of being:

1. Being in our earthly house, this body.
2. Being in our building of God, eternal life.
3. Being naked, unclothed, having neither of the above. (The Grave)

The apostle Paul is simply saying here, "I desire to leave this body and be with the Lord in my immortal body. I want to be absent from this body and present with the Lord." But, and notice this, "not that I want to be naked, or unclothed." Paul does not desire to be in the state where he has neither this body or his immortal body. And what state is that? It is the state of the dead. The dead are now unclothed, naked. They rest in the grave until the resurrection. But they know no time. If believers, their very next moment of consciousness will be with the Lord Jesus Christ.

Matthew 17:1-3… There are people that are now in heaven. One is Moses (see Jude 9). Two others are Enoch and Elijah (see Genesis 5:24; 2 Kings 2:11). Then there were those who were resurrected with Christ (see Matthew 27:52, 53)